



AFTER

After the wounding of General Johnston at Seven Pines on May 31, General Lee was given command of forces that he renamed as the Army of Northern Virginia.

LEE'S STRATEGY

Despite heavy casualties on both sides—more than 4,000 Union and 5,500 Confederate troops killed or wounded—**Seven Pines** was an **indecisive battle** that left the **Army of the Potomac** in a position **threatening Richmond**. Lee's first action on taking command was to **reinforce the earthwork fortifications** around the city—and many expected him to adopt a defensive stance. Instead, Lee ordered General **Stonewall Jackson's army** to join him from the [Shenandoah Valley](#) and began planning an attack on the Union right flank, which would initiate the [Seven Days Battles](#).

McCLELLAN DISCONCERTED

Struck down by malaria, McClellan had been out of action during the battle. Despite **claiming a victory**, he was **demoralized by the heavy casualties** his army had sustained, finding many reasons to **postpone his offensive** against Richmond. He was convinced, contrary to reality, that he faced "overwhelming numbers."